

FACT STATEMENT OF KENNEDY DIXON

Um, hi, I guess you're supposed to start with your name. Mine's Kennedy. I'm 15 years old. I'm a sophomore at Texoma High. I'm not going to "yip," so don't ask. I did not want to give this statement. My parents are making me. It's all part of this grand punishment package they've put on me. I'm grounded until the summer, like six months away. I barely get to use my phone, only at home. That makes the time go by even slower. My parents told me I have to tell the truth in this statement or my punishment would get even worse. They think I did something wrong in all this. I didn't. If I'd seen a sign that Grady Quartz was planning to kill or hurt Julien, I would have totally said something. Grady didn't like Julien, no doubt. He probably disliked Julien more than anyone. You would, too, if you were picked on and bullied for no reason.

I was lab partners with Grady in Coach Flynn's Chemistry class. We became friends the summer before that. We first met at one of those farmer's markets. My parents dragged me to it. Eight on a Saturday morning, gross. Grady's parent, Charlie, was a farmer selling vegetables. Grady was forced to help sell stuff at the market, he later told me. I did feel a bit sorry for him. We chatted while our folks argued over a gourd or something. That was in mid-June. We hit it off. I went over to Grady's house on June 18 for the first time. That's his house on the left of Exhibit 1. We hung out chatting about things. I learned Grady was real big into swimming. He said he practiced at the Texoma pool nearly every day. Grady said it was about a 15 minute walk each direction and that he'd swim laps for about two hours every day to practice. Dedication.

Grady talked a bunch about this mean neighbor, Whitacre, who had harassed him and Charlie. Grady randomly asked me if I had a laser pointer. I did – we have cats at home. I loaned it to Grady, a very small silver one. I was probably Grady's best friend; I think I was his only friend. I knew Julien Younger, too. Well, I knew of him – he was a senior. Way more popular than me. But he wasn't innocent like some people say. Julien teased and bullied me relentlessly when I was a freshman. Not so much now that I'm a sophomore. I don't support murder or violence, obviously. I still can't believe someone about my age died after being poisoned. But Julien was an entitled bully who probably would never have stopped tormenting people. I don't miss him. Crazy thing was, when I left Grady's house that day, I saw an elderly man near the fence line between Grady's house and the neighbor's property. He had binoculars and was looking toward Grady's house. When he saw me, he yelled, "What are you looking at kid?" I just kept walking.

I didn't see Grady much in July. I saw him from a distance on July 4 at a late-night party some of the older kids had organized. They were shooting off fireworks past midnight. I meant to say hi to Grady, but I couldn't find him later. There were 20 or so kids there, so he was easy to miss leaving. He also randomly came by my house in the middle of the day on July 11. He wanted to hang out, but I was in the middle of summer chores my parents had demanded, so he left. Then I saw him at the farmer's market on July 19. He was super friendly, and I thought he was cool. But I heard nothing for weeks. Then he texted me in early August asking me to come over again, and I did on August 2. Grady was really excited about the syllabus in our AP Chemistry class and that we'd been assigned as lab partners. At some point, he apologized for ghosting me. He said he'd been grounded and sent to therapy. That was after Charlie found the laser pointer I loaned to him. He said Whitacre and the cop had accused him of shooting the laser beam at airplanes. I freaked out because my parents would kill me if Grady used my laser pointer like that. But Grady insisted

1 that happened the day before I gave him my laser pointer. I was super relieved. I asked for the
2 laser pointer back. Grady said Charlie had thrown it away – but he promised to get me a new one.
3 He never did, though. I asked him how he'd gotten out for the late July 4 party; he just grinned.
4 I asked if it was just the laser pointer that got him grounded. Grady said it was all of the false
5 claims by the neighbor – claiming Grady shot down a drone, put paint all over the neighbor's car,
6 and the laser. A cop came to his house three times, too. I went over to Grady's house once more
7 before school started on August 13. We played with his chemistry set in the basement, hung out,
8 and had a good time. He was stoked to start high school – but it wasn't a hot start. All because of
9 the bully Julien Younger. I saw Julien tease, make fun of, and bully Grady loads of times at school
10 right from the jump. In the hallways or Chemistry class. I remember plenty of times Julien said
11 mean things to Grady in class. Like the first day, Julien made some loud comment in AP Chemistry
12 that he wasn't aware that toddlers could attend high school now. It was loud enough for everyone
13 to hear it, Coach included, but no one said anything to Julien about it. Just giggles. I told Grady
14 to ignore Julien and he would find a new target. Grady said that he would, but then the swim try-
15 outs happened and Julien started calling Grady "Goldy," like a goldfish.

16
17 I'm not on the swim team. I can barely dog paddle, but I heard all about the sabotage from Grady.
18 Every time Grady told it, the story was exactly the same. Julien, as a senior captain, got to help
19 time some of the laps during try-outs. Julien specifically wanted to time Grady's laps, totally suss.
20 Julien started the stopwatch early so Grady's time would be inflated and longer. Grady said he
21 knows this happened because he hit the wall ahead of Billy Dreskin yet Billy's lap time was
22 reported as faster than Grady's. He told Coach Flynn about it the day the teams were posted; I
23 know because I stood near the doorway to watch and listen. Coach Flynn took Julien's side. Not
24 surprising. Coach thinks Julien walks on water and could never do wrong. I'm sure that only
25 enabled Julien to continue acting like a bully and a jerk. But what really got me was how Coach
26 Flynn wasn't even listening to Grady. Coach hardly even looked at him, as if they couldn't have
27 cared less. I think that made Grady more focused on getting back at Julien. Just guessing, but I
28 don't blame him one bit. It just crushed Grady not to make Varsity. I told him that no freshman
29 makes a Varsity team, but Grady was shook. Julien was all he could talk about after that.

30
31 Grady and I walked home together the day the swim teams were posted. It was about fifteen
32 minutes from Grady's house to mine, and I passed his on the way to mine. We walked home
33 together every day after that. Most times, I left him at his house and continued to mine, but every
34 now and then, I would stay at Grady's for a bit to hang out or work on some homework in his
35 basement. One time right after the swim stuff happened to him, a few days after Labor Day, I was
36 waiting for Grady to change clothes in his room. Charlie started asking me questions about school
37 and such. I basically said "good" to every question but added that I thought Julien was a jerk and
38 unfairly going after Grady. I wanted Charlie to know that things had been pretty unfair to Grady,
39 to support him as my friend you know. Grady came out right then and we headed to the basement
40 to do some homework. That's his basement in Exhibit 6 and his lab equipment too.

41
42 Look, I literally didn't see Grady do anything to Julien's desk, but I'm certain that he rigged it.
43 Grady had been fiddling with the screws in his own desk the day or two before. It was almost like
44 he was figuring out how to take it apart. I asked what he was doing. "Just learning how these are
45 made. They don't seem that sturdy," he said. After Julien's desk disintegrated, Grady whispered
46 to me: "I told you, not sturdy." He had a little smile after he said it. Julien stood and screamed at

1 Grady with his big witchy finger pointed at Grady, and me kind of. Coach Flynn sent Julien to the
2 nurse. Then, Coach searched Grady's backpack but found nothing incriminating. Grady was far
3 too smart for that. Grady offered to let Coach search more but they declined. On the walk home
4 that day, Grady talked a lot about how Julien had looked after his desk fell apart. The next day,
5 he talked all about what Julien had done that day, like Grady was spying on his nemesis.

6
7 A couple days later, the last class had just let out. I was at my locker and this big BANG clapped
8 behind me. I must have jumped a meter. Confetti appeared like rain. I'm still finding that junk
9 in my bag, all over my locker, and even in my room. Julien was on the ground and cursing loudly.
10 The no-no words you can't say at school, ever. He was raging. He punched one of the lockers
11 and dented the dang thing. I distinctly heard him say Grady's name – long, slow, and guttural. I
12 looked around for Grady but didn't see him. So, I texted him on Mist, the text app we all use
13 because your messages are encrypted and deleted automatically after seven days. Grady
14 responded: "Walking home. What's up, did a bomb go off or something?" with several kangaroo
15 emojis. I called Grady when I got that text and asked him how he had found that confetti bomb.
16 Grady just said, "You can find anything on the internet." I said, "What about Julien? He's super
17 angry." Grady replied, "Revenge requires risk." It was odd that Grady hadn't waited for me to
18 walk home, probably the only time he did that.

19
20 Julien tried to fight Grady after school that Friday. I was there because we were about to head
21 home. Julien threatened Grady, grabbed him hard by the shirt, and threw him to the ground. Then,
22 Julien did it again when Grady tried to get up, and again a third time with a mean kick to Grady's
23 ribs. I went to help and told Julien to knock it off, but he leaned into me and snarled, "You want
24 to be next Dixie cup?" That's what Julien called me sometimes to make fun of my last name.
25 Super clever. But I stood there and stared right back at him. Probably the only time I've ever been
26 that brave. Julien walked away. I helped Grady up and we headed home. He was fine by the time
27 we got to his house. I figured he was over Julien by that point; the score had been settled.

28
29 Look, I'll give you the first two – the desk and confetti bomb. Grady did both of those things,
30 even though no one can prove it. But the explosion in lab class, literally impossible. All the
31 chemicals and stuff we use in lab are locked up. Only Coach Flynn has a key. Plus there are
32 cameras everywhere in school now. There's no way Grady could've broken into the locked cabinet
33 without being seen on the security tapes. I know Coach Flynn says Grady must have bought some
34 chemicals online and used those. Sure, it's true that Grady has some pretty serious lab equipment
35 in the basement of his house, but none of that is illegal. Plus he was super safe and had a bunch
36 of protective gear. He also usually kept the window above his lab open so the basement was really
37 ventilated. That's it in Exhibit 8. But even if Grady had snuck in some chemical or solution to
38 prank Julien, Grady never got close to Julien's lab station. We walked in together. Grady was
39 with me at our lab during the whole class up until the explosion. That was a doozy, knocked me
40 off my feet. Those sprinklers in the ceiling must be top of the line. I was drenched in seconds and
41 thought the room would flood. We were all sent outside then sent home after some medical people
42 checked us all out.

43
44 Grady and I decided to hang out at his house since we had a free day. My parents let me – after
45 asking me a thousand times if I was OK since I'd been in the room with the explosion. Grady and
46 I chatted about the explosion, like being there when it happened, but Grady didn't say anything

1 that made me think he had anything to do with it. Not one thing. We did a couple of experiments
2 in the basement for pure fun. Charlie checked on us at least two times and even inspected the
3 experiment once to see what we were up to. I never considered that Grady could've been involved
4 in the lab explosion in Coach Flynn's class until I heard the school had hauled Grady in for a
5 discipline hearing. You don't ever want to be in one of those. I tried to chat with Grady after the
6 hearing, but Charlie was there too and ushered Grady straight to their car. I learned the school
7 suspended Grady for a week. I guess that started the next day because I didn't see Grady for a
8 week. I texted him a couple times during the suspension week, checking in, saying hey. Grady
9 never responded. I figured Charlie had taken his phone away. I honestly felt bad for Grady; it
10 seemed like everyone was ganging up on him with pre-determined beliefs.

11
12 When Grady was back in school, everything seemed to be perfectly normal. Like he'd never been
13 suspended at all. Grady was like a perfect student from that point on. His grades went way up, he
14 did extra credit, and he was nice – like genuinely nice – to Julien every time I saw them interact.
15 I even heard Grady had asked Julien for help in swim practice, tips to get better, to swim better.
16 Like multiple times over the course of October. I heard it from several kids on the swim teams. It
17 was a crazy turnaround – and it lasted the whole semester. We started walking back when he was
18 back from suspension, and I was able to start hanging out at his house again in early October. At
19 first, on the walks home, there was a lot of animated talk by Grady about Julien and Whitacre. He
20 seemed to waver between anger and acceptance; I mostly just listened and tried to support. I asked
21 if Whitacre had messed with him again since Grady seemed to bring up the neighbor out of the
22 blue, but Grady said they hadn't seen Whitacre in ages. It seemed to help Grady to vent and get
23 all of his frustration out about all that. He had truly transformed at school after coming back from
24 suspension. Some kids are good at pretending to be all good and nice, but it never lasts. Grady
25 was different. He asked me in October if he could ship a package to my house since it was some
26 new glass lab equipment. His delivery person was never careful with their packages. I agreed and
27 brought him the package on Saturday since it was delivered late on Friday. I didn't open it. It was
28 his order. I gave it to Grady right in front of Charlie; they seemed to know all about it.

29
30 Grady was really smart on the science stuff, especially chemistry. That's why I think he was so
31 upset after getting a 93 on a lab report we did in AP Chemistry. I got a 100 on mine, and our
32 reports were almost verbatim – that made sense since we were lab partners. Honestly, I couldn't
33 see any difference between my report and Grady's, so I did empathize with him being treated
34 unfairly by Coach. That was October 22. I do need to be clear: Grady wasn't some genius mad
35 scientist. All of the experiments I saw and helped with in his basement were basic biscuit stuff.
36 No dangerous chemicals or anything. I heard Grady tell Charlie a few times that he was working
37 on experiments for a school science fair. I knew that was a lie. There was no school science fair;
38 but Grady was my friend. You don't rat on your friend, especially to one of their parents. Have
39 you seen any movie or TV show where that bodes well for the rat – nope. Some of those
40 experiments gave off an odor, like a sulfuric rotten egg smell, but that is common even in basic
41 chemistry experiments. And since we were in the basement with the window cracked most of the
42 time, the smell never lasted very long.

43
44 Grady asked me if I thought he should ask about competing in the swim championships at the end
45 of November. I said, "No cap. You've been the poster child for a perfect student." Grady nodded
46 and said his therapist had said the same thing. I saw that smile again. Grady asked a few days

1 later and was super jazzed when he told me the school had agreed. I was really happy for him. I
2 know Grady had put in a lot of hard work and extra practice with the swim team. On November
3 9, I was at Grady's house and he showed me a new experiment in the basement. The next day
4 after school, I helped replicate the experiment with Grady. All harmless. Definitely not some
5 toxic poison. But I can't remember exactly what we were doing; I didn't know I needed to take
6 copious notes. Neither of us had goggles or protective gear on; it was that basic. Charlie came
7 downstairs two or three times while we had the experiment going, both days. I do remember a
8 faint sulfuric smell on Sunday, but that was before we started the experiment. The smell was
9 already there. I was amazed at Grady's change in behavior – and how persistent it had been –
10 when I heard Julien had started calling Grady "Goldy" again. I don't know anything about how
11 often that went on in swim practice, but the nickname seemed to come back to life in November.
12 Julien and his friends would say it in class and the hallways, but Grady was cool as a cucumber.

13
14 I was there at the swim championships. I saw Grady swim in the JV races and win both by a long
15 way. It wasn't even close. I waved to Grady at one point and got a wave back, but I didn't see
16 him leave after his last race. At the time, I didn't know that Grady was going on a trip over
17 Thanksgiving. A lot of kids take that week off to travel with their folks, but Grady told me several
18 times before that he didn't have any plans. I remember because he was complaining about Charlie
19 being a farmer and them not having as much money as everyone else. In fact, that was the Saturday
20 when I brought over the beaker set. But later I learned Grady had gone to France with their other
21 parent, Morgan. I didn't know Grady's other parent was even still around; he had never mentioned
22 Morgan before to me. As for me and my family, my grandmother lives in Napa Valley, so we had
23 Thanksgiving there. But boy, all of the turkey talk was about Julien's death. Since I had been at
24 the pool when it all went down, I had to tell the story a bunch of times. Everyone kept asking me.

25
26 It was the very first Varsity race. Julien was in lane two. Even I could tell something was off with
27 him, like he just ran completely out of gas on the last lap. Julien had been in first like the whole
28 race but faded bad at the end. I saw Coach Flynn go up to Julien after that race to talk but Julien
29 walked away. Probably just really angry at losing; Julien was super competitive and a hothead.
30 Julien headed off to the locker room. It was one or two races later when I heard a loud scream
31 coming from that area. Someone shouted to call an ambulance. I saw Coach Flynn sprint to the
32 locker rooms. The races stopped. A bunch of us in the stands were talking even though no one
33 knew anything yet. Sometime later, I saw Coach Flynn come back out and talk to the swimmers
34 and other coaches. Then someone on the loudspeaker said there had been a medical emergency
35 and the rest of the races would be postponed.

36
37 Later, I learned Julien was in the hospital – and then that he died. From a toxic substance. It
38 sounded awful when my parents were describing it based on what they had heard from some of
39 the other parents. No one figured Julien had been murdered at the time. Everyone thought it had
40 been a bad accident or allergic reaction or something. Then my dad said he had heard the police
41 had searched Grady's house twice over the Thanksgiving break. My mom wanted to know about
42 everything I saw inside the house. Nothing out of the ordinary, I repeated. The rumor mill in the
43 parent circle really heated up when word got out that Grady and Morgan were missing in Europe.
44 The police said Grady murdered Julien, and they put out some global search for him. No one has
45 seen him since. I called and texted Grady a couple times after I heard about the police search –
46 just curious if I got through – but my texts were undelivered; my calls never connected.

1
2 I got a little taste of the harassment from Detective Reyne when the cop came to my house and
3 asked my folks to speak with me. That was right after Grady disappeared and we returned from
4 California. Um, my parents are “passionate” and rather opinionated. They are both lawyers, and
5 they peppered the cop with a bunch of questions and legal points that I couldn’t follow. They
6 weren’t arguing with the cop, but it was obvious to me that Detective Reyne was getting really
7 irritated by their stonewalling. I was thrilled; I didn’t want to talk to some cop even though I did
8 nothing wrong. As far as I knew, the cop was eager to blame any kid they could find, so I gave a
9 big smile when they told the cop to leave their property. I’m not sure what changed and why they
10 later forced me to write this statement, but parents be parenting.

11
12 At some point, I was told that the cops found this hidden compartment in the floor of Grady’s room
13 with all kinds of stuff in it. Yep, Exhibit 7. Grady told me about a hidden cubby once before
14 during the summer in early August. But he swore me to secrecy. So, I never told anyone – until
15 now. Grady told me he had found the cubby by accident. It had a rusty tool inside, and Grady
16 assumed it had been some sort of work hatch or something when they were building the house
17 many years ago. But I never saw the cubby itself or heard about anything inside the cubby. Never
18 saw Grady put anything in there or pull anything out. He just talked about it; once. I thought it
19 was cool. Kids need privacy too, you know. And Grady was a clever, crafty kid. It doesn’t
20 surprise me that no one, Charlie included, ever found that hidden compartment until the cops tore
21 up the carpet.

22
23 Further affiant sayeth naught.

24
25 *Kennedy Dixon*

26 KENNEDY DIXON

27 **SIGNED AND SWORN TO BEFORE ME** the undersigned authority on this the 15th
28 day of December, 2025.
29

1 **ADDENDUM TO STATEMENT OF KENNEDY DIXON**

2
3 It feels like ages ago when Julien died and Grady disappeared. I know it's only been a little more
4 than a year, but to me it's felt like a lifetime. I'm a junior now. I've tried to move on from all of
5 this, but it's literally impossible. There is a shrine thing at Julien's old locker. I see it the hallway
6 every day. I'm still finding that stupid confetti every now and then, like little cookie crumbs from
7 Grady or something. I'm focused now on picking a college – one that is far, far away from this
8 crazy place. I used to think it was weird, but this place is on a different level now. Protestors at
9 the farmer's market, rumors of the nastiest type, and news people flooding the town. Some reporter
10 even tried to talk to me at the gas station. My parents went ballistic when I told them and threatened
11 to sue the entire conglomerate that owned the news station.

12
13 You know, I've thought long and hard about whether I could have stopped what Grady did to
14 Julien. Or if there were signs that I missed or should have noticed. But I don't think there was
15 anything I could have done. Grady fooled me completely and kept their parent Charlie even more
16 in the dark. A lot of what I've read is pretty staggering in terms of how sophisticated and con-
17 man-like it all is. Grady truly was fixated on getting back at Julien – all that stuff in October
18 getting close and cozy to Julien while also planning his death – wild. All while leading me,
19 Charlie, Coach Flynn, and everyone else to believe that he had completely changed. The audacity
20 to endure criticism from Julien at swim practice, too. No wonder they've come up with this brand-
21 new disease to describe what must have been happening inside Grady's head – Rexfordism.

22
23 I am a thousand percent sure I had nothing to do with creating that toxin or any part. Nothing
24 smelled like rotten eggs when I was there in mid-November; nothing looked dangerous; we never
25 even wore anything more than eye protectors those two days. Charlie was also in and out of the
26 basement multiple times.

27
28 Finally, I saw in Coach Flynn's statement and one of their emails in Exhibit 2 that they claim to
29 have heard Grady tell me at school that he was planning some revenge on Julien. That never
30 happened; I am absolutely certain. Coach Flynn is either lying or badly misremembering.

31
32 This concludes my sworn testimony.
33

34 *Kennedy Dixon*

35 KENNEDY DIXON

36
37 **SIGNED AND SWORN TO BEFORE ME** the undersigned authority at 8:00 a.m. on this
38 the day of trial.
39
40